Sujal Khatiwada

Software Engineer | Developer Educator | Curriculum Designer

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PROFILE

Software engineer with 6+ years of experience building web apps for real clients. I also design courses and teach programming, and web development with a focus on basics done properly and learning by building approach to create engaging learning experiences.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

PHP documentation: issue report (accepted & fixed)

Feb 2025

Found a bad BCMath example on the PHP 8.4 release docs. It broke under `declare(strict_types=1)`. I opened an issue on the official docs repo; the sample was corrected and merged.

View PHP docs issue on GitHub

sujal/validation: PHP validation library

Open source · MIT

A PHP validation library built around reusable Rule classes. You build an immutable Schema of Fields, hand it to a ValidationEngine, and get pass/fail results with messages instead of a long chain of if statements.

- Built for PHP 8.2+, no framework required.
- Rules like Required, Email, Min/Max, Confirmed, Nested paths, and wildcards (e.g. `items.*.email`).
- Designed around SOLID boundaries so new rules are new classes, not engine changes.
- Covered with PHPUnit tests (`composer test`).

Stack: PHP 8.2+, Composer, PHPUnit

View project on GitHub

voxgig/sdkgen: upstream tooling issues (credited)

2026 · searchapi-google-sdk

While generating a PHP SDK with sdkgen, I hit gaps in the create command, quickstarts, scaffold recovery, and generated metadata. I reported them on the upstream repo; the maintainer opened tracked issues and credited my findings.

#236 · npm create option forwarding (severity: high)

#239 · quickstart required params & API keys (severity: high)

#240 · incomplete projects after scaffold failures (severity: high)

#235 · configurable ownership & publishing metadata (severity: medium)

#237 · actionable optional-component warnings (severity: low)

CASE STUDY

Online learning platform (New York client)

Upwork

Government school in New York · used daily by hundreds of students

Built a learning site for a New York client used in a government school. Students practice languages, science, social studies, and more with vocabularies, audio, visuals, and other interactive activities: less memorizing, more using what they learn.

- Student side for learning, plus a full-featured admin panel to manage content. Some of the features include CSV file uploads, AJAX audio uploads, multi-file drag-and-drop for audio, and bulk photo uploads.
- Suggested the learning methods to the client, then coded them into the product.
- Hundreds of students use it in class on a normal school day.

Stack: PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JS, jQuery

SELECTED WORK

- **Upwork**: 25+ client projects finished, mostly backend, REST APIs, and front-end work.

- **Udemy**: Course instructor for 43,000+ students, teaching programming from the ground up.
- **Community workshops**: Gave training through ITSNP (IT Students of Nepal) and Code for Change (Nepal) on JavaScript and problem-solving.

PROJECTS

- **REST API for an e-commerce store** — Solo project · self-made

  This one is a store API I built myself: products, cart/checkout, user accounts. Backend is in PHP, Symfony, and API Platform framework.

  - Stripe handles card payments; I also added coupon codes.
  - Product images are stored on AWS S3 instead of the application server.
  - Auth uses tokens. For access checks I relied on Symfony voters, and I wrote a few custom validators when the built-in ones fell short.
  - Order confirmations and account emails go out through Symfony Mailer.
  - In `CartRepository` I reworked a query that was causing an N+1 issue.
  - I followed SOLID in places where it helped the code stay easier to change later.

  Stack: PHP, MySQL, Symfony, API Platform, HTML, CSS, JS, Stripe, AWS S3, Symfony Mailer

  View project on GitHub

- **Service Finder (FindNearMe)** — Solo project · self-made

  Prototype of an app to find nearby services (for example a salon), with ratings and basic verification. I wanted local results that feel more trustworthy than a plain web search. Later I may add certified staff badges and a live "how busy are they" signal.

  - Search by name, tags, or location.
  - Business owners get a panel for listings, photos, map, and email verification.
  - Users leave reviews and votes. Admins approve listings, manage categories, and handle users.
  - Core PHP, MySQL, and HTML/CSS/JS (mix of OOP and procedural). I skipped a big framework so I could focus on the product first.

  Stack: PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JS, PHPMailer, TinyMCE, Leaflet, Fancybox

  View project on GitHub

- **Vue Drive (file manager)** — Solo project · self-made

  A Google Drive–style app I built to practice Vue end to end: upload files, nest folders, search, star items, and open recent files. Frontend is Vue 3 with Vite, Vue Router, and Pinia. Backend is a small Express API with JWT login/register and Multer for uploads.

  - Create folders inside folders, rename items, and delete files.
  - Search and sort files; mark important ones as starred.
  - Upload with a drop zone and progress UI.
  - Login and register with hashed passwords and token auth.

  Stack: Vue 3, Vite, Pinia, Vue Router, Express, JWT, bcrypt, Multer, Axios

  View project on GitHub

- **2feat.com** — Frontend only · team project

  On 2feat.com my job was the custom HTML/CSS/JS. When that was done I handed it over. React was someone else's lane.

  - Got the markup and scripts ready for the rest of the team.
  - Sat with React + backend folks when they plugged things together.

  Stack: HTML, CSS, JS | React: other teammates

  Visit 2feat.com

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer at Upwork

Aug 2020 to Present

- Completed 25+ projects for clients: backend work, REST APIs, and responsive UIs.
- Write code with OOP, SOLID, dependency injection, and clean structure when the project needs it.
- Integrated tools like Stripe and Symfony Mailer in live apps.
- Use PHPUnit for unit tests and also test REST APIs end to end before handing work over.
- On team jobs I collect requirements, clear up scope, and keep handoffs tidy with remote teammates.
- Talk directly with clients abroad about what to build and how to ship it.

TEACHING & CURRICULUM DESIGN EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Instructor & Curriculum Designer

2018 – Present

Independent / Online & Community Platforms

- Write courses that start with fundamentals and push students to solve real problems.
- Teach mixed ages, including school kids: from first programs to full projects.
- Build lesson paths that get harder over time so people don't get stuck or bored.
- Coach learners on how software is actually built and delivered in practice.

Udemy Instructor

- 43,000+ students in 150+ countries.
- Main course is programming basics: lots of examples, not much fluff.
- Reviews usually say the teaching is easy to follow. That's what I'm aiming for.

Community & Local Organization Teaching

- **Code for Change (Nepal)**: Ran JS workshops in Kathmandu. Mix of interactive sessions and hands-on coding sessions.
- **IT Students of Nepal**: Sessions on JavaScript on a LIVE workshop of 1 month duration.

EDUCATION

London Metropolitan University: BSc (Hons.) Computing

2023

First Class Honours

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend:** PHP, Symfony, API Platform, MySQL, REST APIs, Doctrine ORM, Stripe payment integration, Symfony Mailer
- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript (Vanilla), Vue.js, Responsive UI Design
- **Testing:** PHPUnit (unit testing), functional testing of REST APIs
- **Core Concepts:** SOLID principles, OOP, Design Patterns, Dependency Injection
- **Tools:** Git, GitHub, Composer, Linux Command Line

SOFT SKILLS

- **Collaboration:** Asking the right questions up front, remote work, client calls, handing work across cleanly
- **Teaching & training:** Workshops, lesson writing, making sure people can still use the skill a month later
- **Communication:** I can talk to a beginner or a senior without switching into buzzword mode
- **Mentorship:** Freshers and switchers usually need a map, not another random YouTube playlist
- **Problem-solving:** Turn unclear requests into working software

LANGUAGES

- **Nepali:** Native language
- **English:** Professional level, both writing and speaking/communication
- **Hindi:** Good communication skill
- **Bhojpuri:** Fluent

- **Bajika:** Speaks and understands
- **Maithili:** Basic to intermediate understanding; limited speaking exposure

LINKS

Udemy Instructor Profile
Upwork Freelance Profile
LinkedIn Profile
GitHub Repository
Portfolio Website